

ORLANDO

I hope so.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Why then, can one desire too much of a good thing?—Come, sister, you shall be the priest and marry us.—Give me your hand, Orlando.—What do you say, sister?

ORLANDO

(*To CELIA*)

Pray thee marry us.

CELIA AS ALIENA

I cannot say the words.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

You must begin 'Will you, Orlando—'

CELIA AS ALIENA

Go to.—Will you, Orlando, have to wife this Rosalind?

ORLANDO

I will.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Ay, but when?

ORLANDO

Why now, as fast as she can marry us.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Then you must say 'I take thee, Rosalind, for wife.'

ORLANDO

I take thee, Rosalind, for wife.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

I might ask you for your commission, but I do take thee, Orlando, for my husband. There's a girl goes before the priest, and certainly a woman's thought runs before her actions.



I WILL BE YOUR ROSALIND IN A MORE COMING-ON DISPOSITION

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

No, faith, die by attorney. The poor world is almost six thousand years old, and in all this time there was not any man died in his own person, videlicet, in a love cause. Troilus had his brains dashed out with a Grecian club, yet he did what he could to die before, and he is one of the patterns of love. Leander, he would have lived many a fair year though Hero had turned nun, if it had not been for a hot midsummer night, for, good youth, he went but forth to wash him in the Hellespont and, being taken with the cramp, was drowned; and the foolish chroniclers of that age found it was Hero of Sestos. But these are all lies. Men have died from time to time and worms have eaten them, but not for love.

ORLANDO

I would not have my right Rosalind of this mind, for I protest her frown might kill me.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

By this hand, it will not kill a fly. But come; now I will be your Rosalind in a more coming-on disposition, and ask me what you will, I will grant it.

ORLANDO

Then love me, Rosalind.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Yes, faith, will I, Fridays and Saturdays and all.

ORLANDO

And wilt thou have me?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Ay, and twenty such.

ORLANDO

What sayest thou?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Are you not good?



WILL YOU, ORLANDO, HAVE TO WIFE THIS ROSALIND?

ORLANDO  
I would kiss before I spoke.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Nay, you were better speak first, and when you were gravelled for lack of matter, you might take occasion to kiss. Very good orators, when they are out, they will spit; and for lovers lacking—God warn us—matter, the cleanliest shift is to kiss.

ORLANDO  
How if the kiss be denied?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Then she puts you to entreaty, and there begins new matter.

ORLANDO  
Who could be out, being before his beloved mistress?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Marry, that should you if I were your mistress, or I should think my honesty ranker than my wit.

ORLANDO  
What, of my suit?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Not out of your apparel, and yet out of your suit. Am not I your Rosalind?

ORLANDO  
I take some joy to say you are because I would be talking of her.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Well, in her person I say I will not have you.

ORLANDO  
Then, in mine own person I die.

ORLANDO  
So do all thoughts. They are winged.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Now tell me how long you would have her after you have possessed her?

ORLANDO  
Forever and a day.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Say 'a day' without the 'ever.' No, no, Orlando, men are April when they woo, December when they wed. Maids are May when they are maids, but the sky changes when they are wives. I will be more jealous of thee than a Barbary cock-pigeon over his hen, more clamorous than a parrot against rain, more newfangled than an ape, more giddy in my desires than a monkey. I will weep for nothing, like Diana in the fountain, and I will do that when you are disposed to be merry. I will laugh like a hyena, and that when thou art inclined to sleep.

ORLANDO  
But will my Rosalind do so?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
By my life, she will do as I do.

ORLANDO  
O, but she is wise.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE  
Or else she could not have the wit to do this. The wiser, the waywarder. Make the doors upon a woman's wit, and it will out at the casement. Shut that, and 'twill out at the keyhole. Stop that, 'twill fly with the smoke out at the chimney.

ORLANDO  
A man that had a wife with such a wit, he might say 'Wit, whither wilt?'

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Nay, you might keep that check for it till you met your wife's wit going to your neighbour's bed.

ORLANDO

And what wit could wit have to excuse that?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Marry, to say she came to seek you there. You shall never take her without her answer unless you take her without her tongue. O, that woman that cannot make her fault her husband's occasion, let her never nurse her child herself, for she will breed it like a fool.

ORLANDO

For these two hours, Rosalind, I will leave thee.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Alas, dear love, I cannot lack thee two hours.

ORLANDO

I must attend the Duke at dinner. By two o'clock I will be with thee again.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Ay, go your ways, go your ways. I knew what you would prove. My friends told me as much, and I thought no less. That flattering tongue of yours won me. 'Tis but one cast away, and so, come, death. Two o'clock is your hour?

ORLANDO

Ay, sweet Rosalind.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

By my troth, and in good earnest, and so God mend me, and by all pretty oaths that are not dangerous, if you break one jot of your promise or come one minute behind your hour, I will think you the most pathological break-promise, and the most hollow lover, and the most unworthy of her you call Rosalind that may be chosen out of the gross band of the unfaithful. Therefore beware my censure, and keep your promise.

ORLANDO

Pardon me, dear Rosalind.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Nay, an you be so tardy, come no more in my sight. I had as lief be wooed of a snail.

ORLANDO

Of a snail?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Ay, of a snail, for though he comes slowly, he carries his house on his head—a better jointure, I think, than you make a woman. Besides, he brings his destiny with him.

ORLANDO

What's that?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Why, horns, which such as you are fain to be beholding to your wives for. But he comes armed in his fortune and prevents the slander of his wife.

ORLANDO

Virtue is no hornmaker, and my Rosalind is virtuous.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

And I am your Rosalind.

CELIA AS ALIENA

It pleases him to call you so, but he hath a Rosalind of a better leer than you.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

(*To ORLANDO*)

Come, woo me, woo me, for now I am in a holiday humour, and like enough to consent. What would you say to me now an I were your very, very Rosalind?

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

A traveller. By my faith, you have great reason to be sad. I fear you have sold your own lands to see other men's. Then to have seen much and to have nothing is to have rich eyes and poor hands.

JACQUES

Yes, I have gained my experience.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

And your experience makes you sad. I had rather have a fool to make me merry than experience to make me sad—and to travel for it too.

*(Enter ORLANDO.)*

ORLANDO

Good day and happiness, dear Rosalind.

JACQUES

Nay then, God be wi' you, an you talk in blank verse.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Farewell, Monsieur Traveller. Look you lisp and wear strange suits, disable all the benefits of your own country, be out of love with your nativity, and almost chide God for making you that countenance you are, or I will scarce think you have swam in a gondola.

*(Exit JACQUES.)*

Why, how now, Orlando, where have you been all this while? You a lover? An you serve me such another trick, never come in my sight more.

ORLANDO

My fair Rosalind, I come within an hour of my promise.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Break an hour's promise in love? He that will divide a minute into a thousand parts and break but a part of the thousand part of a minute in the affairs of love, it may be said of him that Cupid hath clapped him o' th' shoulder, but I'll warrant him heart-whole.



THAT BLIND RASCALLY BOY

ORLANDO

With no less religion than if thou wert indeed my Rosalind. So, adieu.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Well, time is the old justice that examines all such offenders, and let time try. Adieu.

(*Exit ORLANDO.*)

CELLIA

You have simply misused our sex in your love-prate. We must have your doublet and hose plucked over your head and show the world what the bird hath done to her own nest.

ROSALIND

O coz, coz, my pretty little coz, that thou didst know how many fathom deep I am in love. But it cannot be sounded; my affection hath an unknown bottom, like the Bay of Portugal.

CELLIA

Or rather bottomless, that as fast as you pour affection in, it runs out.

ROSALIND

No, that same wicked bastard of Venus, that was begot of thought, conceived of spleen, and born of madness, that blind rascally boy that abuses everyone's eyes because his own are out, let him be judge how deep I am in love. I'll tell thee, Aliena, I cannot be out of the sight of Orlando. I'll go find a shadow and sigh till he come.

CELLIA

And I'll sleep.

(*Exeunt omnes.*)

## Scene 1

### *The Forest of Arden*

(*Enter ROSALIND as GANYMEDE, CELIA as ALIENA, and JACQUES.*)

JACQUES

I prithee, pretty youth, let me be better acquainted with thee.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

They say you are a melancholy fellow.

JACQUES

I am so. I do love it better than laughing.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Those that are in extremity of either are abominable fellows and betray themselves to every modern censure worse than drunkards.

JACQUES

Why, 'tis good to be sad and say nothing.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

Why then, 'tis good to be a post.

JACQUES

I have neither the scholar's melancholy, which is emulation; nor the musician's, which is fantastical; nor the courtier's, which is proud; nor the soldier's, which is ambitious; nor the lawyer's, which is politic; nor the lady's, which is nice; nor the lover's, which is all these; but it is a melancholy of mine own, compounded of many simples, extracted from many objects, and indeed the sundry contemplation of my travels, in which my often rumination wraps me in a most humorous sadness.





THE HORN, THE HORN, THE LUSTY HORN

